

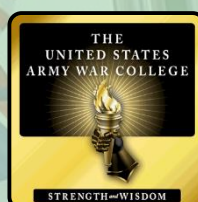
INTERNATIONAL STRATEGIC CRISIS

ISCNE

NEGOTIATION EXERCISE



Cyprus Scenario



The International Strategic Crisis Negotiation Exercise

Exercise Description and Guidance

Introduction

The International Strategic Crisis Negotiation Exercise (ISCNE) uses experiential learning to educate participants in the process of crisis negotiations at the international/strategic level.

Participants, as part of a delegation, will be challenged in leadership styles, negotiating techniques, and communications abilities to reach their team's desired end-state. Each delegation engages with counterparts, within the framework of a United Nations conference, to try to resolve a long-standing and potentially volatile crisis. An actual complete resolution to the presented issues is not an expectation, nor is it a reality. Delegations will have to contend with teams that each have their own desired end-state goals.

The crisis being exercised is crisis on Cyprus. Those with interests in this region and involved in the negotiations are Cyprus, Greece, Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus, Turkey, United Kingdom, and the United States. The Special Representative of the Secretary-General (SRSG) in Cyprus represents the UN. They will monitor developments, mediate negotiations and discussions, and report findings.

The key documents provided are the Cyprus Scenario, Privileged Instructions, and relevant reference documents. As the name implies the Privileged Instructions are protected communications from each government to their negotiation delegations regarding the impending round of talks and need to be handled as such.

This type of exercise works best when conducted within the confines of a strict schedule. This allows the parties involved time to negotiate issues, pause to evaluate and adjust their negotiation strategies, and schedule and respond to negotiation requests. The structure may induce some frustration, but this is not unrealistic. Within the context of this exercise all parties have accepted a UN negotiation model which establishes the structure and employs a control group concept.

Preparation for the Exercise

It is highly recommended that each delegation find time to meet and prepare prior to the exercise.

Each delegation must have both a Head of Delegation (HOD) and a Team Communicator.

As the title implies, the HOD is the delegation lead. This person is responsible for providing direction to the delegation and is responsible to their superiors, in the form of their Foreign Minister/Secretary (FM/S) as role-played by Mr. Ed "Cliffy" Zukowski. Which negotiation sessions the HOD elects to attend (or not to attend), is symbolic of their significance within diplomatic circles.

The Team Communicator is a full team member that has the additional duty of being the delegation's point of contact with the exercise control team. They are responsible for requesting and processing ad hoc negotiation invitations, team-to-team communication and diplomatic communiques as detailed below. This duty is critical for exercise execution.

Exercise Operations

As part of the United Nations' efforts, all parties agreed to the imposition of certain predetermined sessions and control mechanisms to ensure the proper conduct of the negotiations. For that purpose, a UN Control Group (UNCG) has been established, as the technical and administrative branch of the SRSG, to help manage the conduct of this peace conference and ensure implementation of the agreed mechanisms. These mechanisms are:

- **Ad Hoc Negotiation Scheduling:** Ad Hoc negotiation sessions are scheduled via an electronic system accessed by your delegation's communicator (not by direct delegation-to-delegation communication). Ad Hoc sessions must adhere to the negotiation periods set out in the exercise schedule. Sessions may be bilateral or multilateral and may be requested for 15- or 30-minute increments. Invited parties may *accept*, *decline*, or *ignore* the invitation. Once all invitees have responded, the system notifies all parties on whether the session will be held and if so, where. **Ad Hoc Negotiation Sessions only happen if all parties agree to attend.** A delegation may request and schedule as many negotiation sessions as it can support within the allotted time. **If you accept an invitation, you must attend the session.**

The SRSG will be available to meet with delegation(s) during Ad Hoc Negotiation sessions. All requests to meet with the SRSG are initiated in the same manner as ad hoc negotiation sessions. The SRSG has the option to call their own Ad Hoc Negotiation sessions; if so, these requests **cannot** be declined or ignored.

- **Diplomatic Communiqués:** These are messages to your nation's leadership to either provide reports or to request guidance. Mr. Ed "Cliffy" Zukowski role-plays the FM/S. He will provide his cell phone number to the Head of Delegation and Team Communicator so that they can text him directly. If a delegation would like to meet with him, he will come to your team room during Team Meeting periods.
- **Team-to-Team Communication:** Delegations are allowed to communicate with each other as they determine appropriate but **may not conduct negotiations outside of formally scheduled negotiation sessions.**
- **Exercise Schedule:** Adherence to the exercise schedule will be strictly enforced. Team Meeting periods are an extremely important element, as they are a time for internal team communication, evaluation/reevaluation of positions and interests of the other delegations, consultation with their FM/S, scheduling negotiation sessions, and establishing talking points for the next round of negotiations. Negotiation sessions between delegations can only take place during the scheduled negotiation periods.

Conduct of the Exercise

The exercise begins following the exercise overview brief. At the opening plenary session, chaired by the SRSG, role-playing portion of the exercise begins. Participants should remain in role throughout. Negotiation sessions and team meetings are confidential but conversations in common or public areas are subject to intelligence collection.

For the opening plenary each delegation should be prepared to present a 2-3 minute opening statement. Upon conclusion of the plenary participants will move to their team rooms and prepare for the commencement of negotiations. The first negotiation period consists of pre-scheduled bilateral sessions. Thereafter, all negotiation sessions will be Ad Hoc, conducted as described above. The first day concludes with an internal team evaluation of the day's events.

The second day begins with a Team Meeting period followed by the resumption of negotiations. At the end of the day teams will reassemble for a closing plenary chaired by the SRSG. ***During the closing plenary each delegation will brief their current positions, assess the progress made, and offer options for any proposed way forward.*** Specific instructions on the closing plenary will be sent to each delegation during the last Ad Hoc negotiation session. At the conclusion of the plenary participants will come out of role and the Army War College will facilitate an after-action review.

INTERNATIONAL STRATEGIC CRISIS NEGOTIATION EXERCISE

Cyprus Scenario



The scenario utilized for this exercise depicts an evolving situation regarding the long-standing crisis on the island of Cyprus. The scenario's purpose is to provide a near real world situation and set the stage for delegation team negotiations which are the primary actions of the exercise.

The scenario is completely hypothetical and has been designed solely as an aid to achieve participant educational learning objectives. All materials in this exercise are notional for educational purposes only. There is no attempt to be predictive or reach a real-world solution.

Cyprus Scenario References ([Reference Link](#))

Note: The United States Government does not recognize the "Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus." Usage of the terms "Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus" and "TRNC" in this exercise, being administered by the United States Army War College, is used for educational purposes only and does not reflect a contradiction to the United States Government official stance.

Historic Background

Cyprus, an island in the Eastern Mediterranean Sea, is located at the crossroads of great historic civilizations. Each has left its mark on this island. Around 1500 BCE the Egyptians exploited the island's agricultural wealth but did not establish any settlements. It was the Phoenicians who first left their mark. The Phoenicians build coastal trading posts which eventually developed into cities. They were followed by the Ægeans from the island of Crete.

Ægeans were a collection of historic Greek peoples. Early Greek peoples were a collection of city-states linked by similar cultures. These city-states were more easily linked by sea than by land and as such these states strengthened their sea power and increased their trade throughout the Eastern Mediterranean Sea. Maps from the twelfth century BCE show Greek settlements on Cyprus. By then they had begun to further develop the island's main cities and continue to populate it.

The Assyrians conquered the island and then they were followed by the Persians in 525 BCE. The Persians ruled until the rise of Alexander the Great. Alexander imposed the Greek nation model, known as Hellenism, on Cyprus. Following Alexander's death Cyprus remained under Hellenism for the next 300 years. This ended with the rise of the Roman Empire.

Cyprus remained under Roman rule until the death of Constantine the Great in 364 CE. With the split of the Holy Roman Empire, Cyprus was apportioned to the Byzantine Empire.

Cyprus as Part of the Byzantine Empire

The Byzantine Empire lasted for over a thousand years (395-1453). During this period, history witnessed the demise of the Western Holy Roman Empire, the firm establishment of the Christian religion and the emergence of Roman-style government and Greek culture throughout Byzantium. Cyprus became a province of the Diocese of the East and was administered by the consularis (Emperor's representatives).

The Church of Cyprus became an increasingly independent force, which, through direct appeals to the Emperor, won the right to elect its own Archbishop. The power of the Archbishop would have great significance throughout the island's history.

With the rise of Islam on the Arabian Peninsula and throughout Persia a clash of empires was beginning to develop. The Christian church broke apart during the Great Schism, in 1064, which resulted in a permanent division between the Byzantine Eastern Orthodoxy and Roman Catholicism.

Due to this break the Byzantine Empire weakened. The Seljuk Turks, originating from Central Asia, moved against the caliphs of Baghdad and seized the Holy Lands. This defeat of the Byzantine Emperor forced a deal with the Roman Catholic Pope to provide assistance in regaining the Holy Lands. In 1096 the first of eight Crusades was initiated to recapture the Holy Lands.

HISTORIC TIMELINE	
Pharaohs	2000
Alexander & Ptolemy	1000
Roman Province	1 CE
	100
	200
	300
	400
Byzantine Period	500
	600
	700
	800
	900
Richard I of England	1000
	1100
	1200
	1300
	1400
Lusignan Dynasty	1500
	1600
Venetian Rule	1700
Turkish Rule	1800
	1900
	2000
British Colony Independence	

Cyprus Under the Influence of Europe

During the Third Crusade (1191), Richard I of England gained control of Cyprus as a base for his forces. For the next 400 years the island remained under the domain of Western powers as feudal state with a class system. In 1369 the last crusading Cypriot King, Pierre, died and with him so did the crusading spirit. Following this time Cyprus became the center of trade between West and East. The Cypriot merchant class amassed great wealth and Cyprus became the target of attack by regional powers.

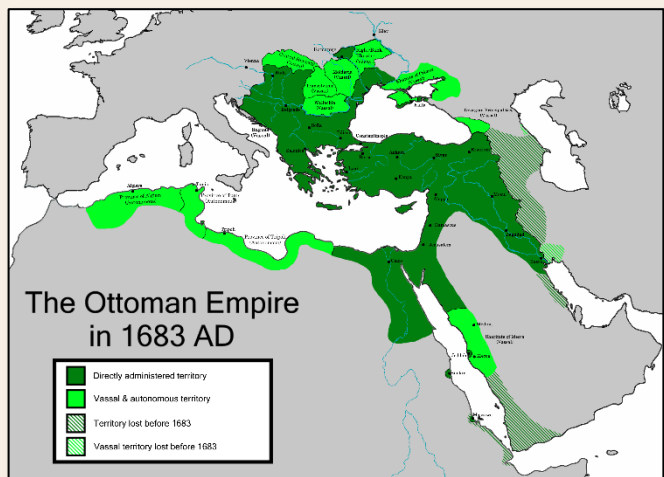
The fall of Constantinople, in 1453, the Byzantine Empire came to an end. The initial power vacuum in the Mediterranean was filled by the Venetians and the Ottoman Turks consolidated power in Asia Minor. The Venetians developed Cyprus into their centerpiece of Eastern Mediterranean trade. They improved the ports and infrastructure on the island. The Venetians imposed the Latin hierarchy and Roman Catholic teachings. The Ottomans continued to grow unabated with gains in Syria and Egypt. In the summer of 1570 the Ottoman fleet attacked Cyprus. Ottoman forces outnumbered Venetian forces and the island fell in 1571.

With the increased turmoil in the Eastern Mediterranean, and the established European-Asian sea route (Cape Route), Western European nations reduced trading through Cyprus. The peoples of Cyprus became a lesser province of the Ottoman Empire. Basically a Christian island within a vast Moslem sea.

Cyprus Within the Ottoman Empire

The Ottoman Sultan's government enacted a census to determine the taxable population and 150,000 native Cypriots were counted. The Ottoman custom was to allow conquered lands to exercise their non-Moslem religion for a fee. The Cypriots re-established the Greek Orthodox Church as the island's only recognized Christian denomination. Additionally they restored the Archbishopric for the first time in 300 years.

Along with the soldiers, of the conquering Ottomans, some 30,000 Turks soon established themselves as residents. Many became landholders through the generosity of the Sultan.



The Ottoman Empire at its greatest extent

Throughout the sixteenth and seventeenth centuries there were a series of armed revolts against Ottoman taxes. These revolts often united Greek and Turkish Cypriots. Governors of the island were relatively powerless and relied on community leaders to aid in quelling uprisings. The Greek Cypriots were represented by bishops of the Eastern Orthodox Church. The power of the Archbishop grew and in 1660 the Ottomans recognized the Archbishop as the guardian and representative of the Cypriot people. In 1754 the Archbishop was made responsible for collecting taxes and was given the right to appoint the head of the civil service.

In the later part of the eighteenth century Catherine the Great of Russia developed the Greek Project. Her concern, regarding Orthodox Christians under Ottoman rule, was to try and re-establish the Eastern Roman Empire centered in Constantinople. In 1821 revolts broke out throughout Greek-speaking provinces of the Ottoman Empire. Though Greece ultimately won independence in 1832 the

Cypriot uprising was put down. The Archbishop, and his supporters, were put to death on grounds of treachery.

Russia continued, throughout the nineteenth century, fighting with the Ottoman Empire. At the same time British expansion continued to put checks on Russian ambitions. In 1869 the Suez Canal was completed and once again trade through the Eastern Mediterranean Sea was profitable. In 1878 a secret agreement was reached between the United Kingdom and the Ottoman Empire for control of Cyprus. In exchange for Cyprus, for an annual fee, the British agreed to support the Ottomans during the Congress of Berlin. The convention stipulated that if Russia returned Eastern Anatolia to the Ottoman Empire then Great Britain would relinquish control of Cyprus. In the end Russia did not return Eastern Anatolia and Cyprus remained under British control. The agreement further permitted the British government to purchase land on the island for public purposes. This expanded British influence on the island and opened Cyprus to the West.

British Rule: Back to Europe

When the island's new English High Commissioner arrived in July 1878, he came with Queen Victoria's acclamation that the population be graced with "freedom, justice and security," all the benefits of a modern society while still respecting Cypriot customs and traditions. The island's police force was reformed under British standards and training. The establishment of a proper education system (in both English and Greek) became an early focus, as did much needed infrastructure projects, with the construction of new roads and bridges along with harbor repair and improvements. The new commissioner found that the island's inhabitants lived in peace with each other, much as British vice-consul, H. P. White, noted in a report to London:

"Brigandage, burglaries and assassinations are so rare as to be almost unknown in Cyprus; political agitation or opposition on the part of the people to the constituted authority is equally unknown. The Moslems....live in harmony with their Christian neighbors in town and country..."

A Legislative Council was set up consisting of 18 members – 6 being British government officials, 9 being non-Moslem and 3 being Moslem – with the British High Commissioner at its head. This was to have been a temporary arrangement, lasting only until the establishment of a constitution and the installment of a freely elected government, but in fact the council remained in place for fifty years.

In 1914 the Ottoman Empire and Germany signed a mutual defense treaty. This pact placed the Ottomans and Great Britain on opposing sides during World War I, thus ending all agreements between the two and allow full annexation of Cyprus to Great Britain. In 1915 Britain offered Cyprus to the Greek King, on condition that Greece joined the war on Britain's side, which he declined. In 1925 Great Britain declared Cyprus a Crown Colony, replacing the High Commissioner with a Governor. This final movement from Ottoman influence encouraged Greek Cypriots to believe that *enosis* (union) with Greece was finally possible. Turkish Cypriots were unsympathetic to their Greek neighbors as they had no desire to become part of Greece but would rather maintain the status quo.



A Greek Cypriot demonstration in favor of enosis with Greece

In 1931 an open revolt occurred which resulted in the death of 6 civilians. The British Governor called in troops to put down the disturbance. He deported instigators and fined the Greek Cypriot residents. He abolished the Legislative Council and the constitution and assumed all decision-making powers. He enacted the 28 "illiberal laws" which included press censorship, a ban on political parties, the abolition of municipal elections, and expanded police powers. In opposition, these measures strengthened workers' unions, increased the frequency of strikes, and drove the political efforts of the Greek Cypriots underground – in effect paving the way for the guerrilla war to come. Despite these actions and the ongoing conflicts between the evolving nations of Greece and Türkiye, relations among the island's Greek and Turkish communities remained peaceful.

The start of World War II saw a significant increase in the British and allied forces on the island along with commensurate military-related construction. Greece entered the war on the side of the allies, while Türkiye maintained neutrality. Cypriots were recruited to the British armed forces and many Greek Cypriots joined the Greek Army. While enduring some scattered attacks early on, for the most part the island remained relatively secure and peaceful during the majority of the war. Throughout the war years, Greek Cypriot desire for the cession of Cyprus to Greece continued to grow, fueled in no small part by Churchill and Roosevelt in the principles they codified as part of the 1941 Atlantic Charter:

Second, they desire to see no territorial changes that do not accord with the freely expressed wishes of the peoples concerned....Third, they respect the right of all peoples to choose the form of government under which they will live; and they wish to see sovereign rights and self-government restored to those who have been forcibly deprived of them.

In response, the Turkish Cypriots discussed with the British government their opposition to ceding the island to Greece, emphasizing their support for continued British rule. As WWII ended, both Greece and the Greek Cypriots expected quick action by the British government to cede the island to Greece. However, the British leadership was not of one voice on the subject. The Foreign Office favored ceding the island, but the Colonial Office, citing the island's strategic value, favored the status quo and would not yield. The Greek government, while favoring the annexation of Cyprus, was heavily dependent on the United Kingdom and the United States for the nation's survival, and thus was in no position to support *enosis*.

The West's race to halt the growth of the Soviet Union demanded a strategic platform in the Mediterranean Sea. Unfortunately for Greek Cypriots, the island's ideal location cast Cyprus as a pawn in the chess match of Western security.

The British Governor struggled to create an administrative structure acceptable to the Greek and Turkish communities. In 1946 he created a Consultative Assembly to advise him on internal affairs and form a new constitution. In July 1948, King Paul of Greece, publicly asserted Greece's desire for union with Cyprus in exchange for the establishment of UK or US military bases elsewhere in Greece. By August of 1948, citing little progress, the British Governor dissolved the assembly and ceased all work on a constitution for the next six years.

Archbishop Makarios III, primate of the Cypriot Orthodox Church, actively supported the idea Cyprus would gain the right of self-determination. He eventually dismissed the possibility of achieving *enosis* through peaceful means and asserted that it could only be won through "continuous struggle."



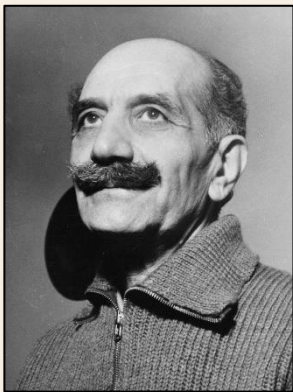
Archbishop Makarios

The people of Cyprus demanded to be heard. The AKEL (The Progressive Party of Working People) shifted to an uncompromising *enosis* policy. From the end of WWII throughout the early 1950s labor strikes often turned violent and the English Governor enforced limitations to basic freedoms as he saw fit under the still existing “illiberal laws.” As Greek Cypriot voices grew louder, so did those of the Turkish community in opposition as they increasingly expressed their sentiment for union with Türkiye.

The 1950s were one of the most troubled decades in the modern history of Cyprus. The island would experience an intense guerrilla war, the deportation and return of Archbishop Makarios, and several attempts at negotiating an acceptable resolution of the island’s status. This period also saw the first significant inter-communal violence between the Greek and Turkish Cypriots followed by growing animosity and hardening of positions between both communities, a fundamental problem that plagues peace negotiations to this day.

Turbulence Leads to the Threshold of Independence

The 1950s were one of the most troubled decades in the modern history of Cyprus. While the suffering would ultimately lead to independence in 1960, the island would experience an intense guerrilla war, the deportation and return of Archbishop Makarios, and several attempts at negotiating an acceptable resolution of the island’s status. This period also saw the first significant inter-communal violence between the Greek and Turkish Cypriots followed by growing animosity and hardening of positions between both communities, a fundamental problem that plagues peace negotiations to this day.



Colonel Georgios
Grivas

This period also saw the rise of a major figure in the Greek Cypriot fight for *enosis* – Georgios Grivas. Grivas, a Greek Cypriot, was a retired Colonel of the Greek Army and a WWI and WWII veteran. During WWII he led an anti-communist resistance group in Greece. After his return to Cyprus he formed EOKA (National Organization of Greek Cypriot Fighters) and began campaigning to end the status of Cyprus as a British crown colony.

In 1952 both Greece and Türkiye were admitted to NATO. The following year the two nations signed a Treaty of Friendship and Cooperation, followed in 1954 by a Treaty of Alliance. A new era of peace and cooperation had begun between the two nations.

The continued intransigence of the British government finally eroded Greek patience. In early 1955, Greek Prime Minister Papagos appealed directly to the UN Secretary General to regard Cyprus not as an internal matter of the United Kingdom, but rather as an international issue. Papagos also lent his support to EOKA. The campaign began in the early hours of 1 April 1955, with the bombing of several government buildings and facilities across the island, followed by the distribution of leaflets announcing EOKA. Archbishop Makarios had envisioned a three-month sabotage campaign followed by British capitulation to Cypriot demands ended up being a decade-long guerilla war between EOKA and a British military force that would eventually number 30,000 troops.

At first EOKA leaders took very deliberate steps to make sure that their fighters left the Turkish Cypriot community in peace, as they had no issues with their neighbors. But they also did not reach out to them to seek a mutual alliance against the British occupation. The British took advantage of this by encouraging the Turkish government to become more involved in the affairs of their Turkish Cypriot brethren. For their part, the Turkish government began to make their views known, stating that Cyprus must be seen as a tripartite problem between Britain, Greece and Türkiye. The British



National Organization of Greek Cypriot Fighters

Foreign Secretary, Harold Macmillan, successfully convinced both of his Turkish and Greek counterparts to attend a tripartite conference. As Macmillan had hoped, the meeting only served to emphasize the differences between Ankara and Athens regarding Cyprus and allowed Britain to appear as the neutral moderator of a Turkish/Greek dispute.

On 6 September 1955, an explosion at the Turkish consulate in the Greek city of Thessaloniki sparked anti-Greek demonstrations in Istanbul which rapidly

expanded into widespread rioting. The initial demonstrations were covertly planned by the Turkish government to put pressure on the US to oppose placing Cyprus on the UN General Assembly agenda; however, violent elements infiltrated the demonstrations and the plan spiraled out of control. These incidents fractured Greek-Turkish relations, provoked anti-Turkish and anti-NATO riots in Greece, and caused Athens to reconsider its position regarding its alliance with Western nations and its membership in NATO. The US and its European allies worked to repair relations with Greece as they feared the Soviets would step in and seek to exploit the situation to their own advantage.

As 1956 began, Cyprus settled into what increasingly resembled a police state. The EOKA insurgency was conducting their campaign and continued to hold the support of the Greek Cypriot population. In a speech in June of 1956, British Prime Minister Eden stated: "No Cyprus, no certain facilities to protect our supply of oil. No oil, unemployment and hunger in Britain. It is as simple as that." The government needed to find a way to bring peace to Cyprus while still maintaining it as part of the Commonwealth. They chose to negotiate directly with Archbishop Makarios, but when several proposals were rejected and the Archbishop maintained his call for self-determination, the British government exiled him to the Seychelles. His exile proved a calculated error, as no one else in the Greek Cypriot community would step forward to represent their interests at the negotiation table. This vacuum left EOKA as the only voice of the Greek Cypriots. Without Makarios' calming influence the resistance movement was left unconstrained, mounting more frequent and intense attacks against the British.

The calm that existed between the Greek and Turkish Cypriot communities ended in January 1956 when a Turkish police sergeant was killed by Greek Cypriots, inciting Turkish Cypriot reprisals against Greek businesses. Violent incidents between the two communities continued throughout 1956 into early 1957, forcing the creation of a barrier dividing the capital of Nicosia. This divide presaged the Green Line that would eventually split the island into two separate communities. During this time, the British conducted separate talks with the Turkish government over the status of the island's Turkish community, urging them to become more involved in talks over the island's status. This was a British tactic to divide the Cypriot communities to ensure that Cyprus remained under British rule as a partitioned island.

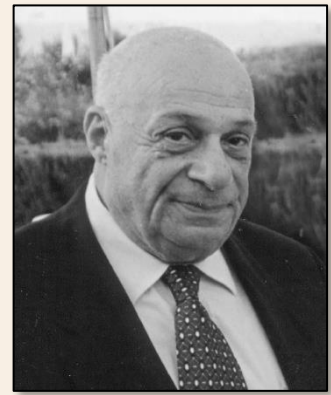
The Difficult Path to Independence: 1957-1960

As the world entered 1957 there was little hope in Britain that Cyprus would remain part of the Commonwealth. There had been no substantive negotiations in almost a year. British troop morale suffered under the near-constant EOKA attacks.

The Turkish Cypriot community formed militias to counterbalance EOKA. The Turkish Resistance Organisation (TMT), founded and led by Rauf Denktaş, became a prominent face of *taksim* (partition

of Cyprus into Turkish and Greek portions). They claimed their efforts were in response to real threats against their community by EOKA.

Amidst increasing violence and stalemated negotiations, the British were determined to move things forward. First, Britain sought to change Washington's approach from a policy of 'quiet diplomacy' in its dealings with both Greece and Türkiye, to a more publicly active role regarding Cyprus. Second, Britain realized that Archbishop Makarios was the only reliable and authoritative voice of the Greek Cypriot community and the only hope of containing EOKA, so in April 1957 he was returned from exile – to Athens, not to Cyprus – and Britain recognized him as the leader of the Greek Cypriots, hoping that these steps would allow negotiations to resume in earnest.



Rauf Denktaş

Britain's opening proposal was that the island be jointly governed by Britain, Greece and Türkiye, with its sovereignty held in partnership. The UK would reserve certain military enclaves as exclusive British sovereign areas and internal affairs would be handled by a governor, aided by an advisory council, and two communal assemblies. After much discussion with the Turkish and Greek governments, Ankara accepted the proposal. The Greek government, on the other hand, while not wishing to further aggravate their already strained relations with Türkiye and NATO, reiterated their position that the Cypriot community had the right of self-determination. Of specific concern to the Greeks was Turkish and Turkish Cypriot intransigent insistence on partition into two autonomous states (*taksim*). Archbishop Makarios supported the Greek position but allowed that it was possible to accept some form of self-governance as a step towards self-determination and the eventual realization of *enosis*. He also sought increased US involvement in arriving at a solution, and expressly sought UN support for the right of self-determination consistent with democratic principles.

Rauf Denktaş began to be the counterpart to Archbishop Makarios, as the acknowledged spokesman for the Turkish Cypriot community. During these days of turmoil and uncertainty, Denktaş was prone to highly incendiary speeches that contributed to the radicalization of the Turkish Cypriot community, which often led to violent clashes between the Turkish and Greek communities.

British negotiators took a more aggressive tack with a new draft agreement, framed in May 1958, which proposed continued British sovereignty over the island and appointed both Greek and Turkish High Commissioners. Governance would be administered by a British Governor, a Governor's Council, and a House of Representatives for each community. The proposal was immediately rejected by Türkiye, who continued to call for partition as the only solution that protected Turkish interests. Embroiled in a government crisis, Greece neither accepted nor rejected the initiative. Archbishop Makarios rejected the plan and expressed, along with others, the fear that any type of agreement along these lines would divide the island.

During this time the Turkish Cypriot community began moving families and entire communities from predominantly Greek areas of the island to Turkish areas. They also forced Greek Cypriot residents out of Turkish areas. With the island close to civil war, British Governor Hugh Foot called for a cease-fire. Both EOKA and TMT complied, but splinter groups refused to stand-down and continued to press their agendas.

A 'seven-year partnership plan' draft agreement was developed and established limited self-rule, overseen by the United Kingdom, Greece, and Türkiye, with a final decision on status to be determined after a seven-year period. The Greek government and Archbishop Makarios rejected the plan, instead preferring to work through the UN. Türkiye softened its stance on *taksim* and accepted the plan, due in part to pressure from both the UK and the US. In December the Greek government

introduced a motion in the UN General Assembly which laid out a plan for Cyprus consisting of a period of self-rule leading to full independence. Several other proposals were put forward by various nations. Ultimately, the assembly approved a watered-down Mexican proposal that simply urged further talks.

During the UN debate, the Foreign Ministers of Greece and Türkiye met informally and had an extensive conversation about the Cyprus situation. This led to formal talks in Paris, which included the British Foreign Secretary. On 11 February the Greek and Turkish premiers initialed a declaration affirming the independence of Cyprus. At a London conference a week later Greek and Turkish Cypriot delegations were brought in, not to talk, but to accept the agreement as presented (known as the London and Zürich Agreements), which they did. The agreement was ratified by the parliaments of the United Kingdom, Greece and Türkiye.



London and Zürich Agreements Signing

The treaty consisted of two main parts: a constitution and three treaties. The constitution established a government that consisted of a Greek Cypriot President and Turkish Cypriot vice-president, a council of ministers, a single-chamber house of representatives, a military, and justice system. The three treaties consisted of 1) The Treaty of Guarantee, which in essence prevented both *enosis* and *taksim*; 2) The Treaty of Alliance, which provided for the common defense through the emplacement of Greek and Turkish military forces on the island (contingents of 950 Greek & 650 Turkish troops) and for the joint or individual action in Cyprus with the sole aim of reestablishing its independence, territorial integrity and security, as well as respect for its constitution; and 3) The Treaty of Establishment, which allowed for the establishment of permanent British military bases on the island. The last two treaties established the presence of military forces from three nations on Cyprus.



Dr. Fazıl Küçük

Shortly after the treaties were signed, Archbishop Makarios returned to Cyprus and assumed the position as the Greek Cypriot leader. He became part of the tripartite transitional government, along with Dr. Fazıl Küçük, as the Turkish Cypriot leader, and Governor Foot. The Greek Prime Minister called on EOKA to lay down their arms and embrace the settlement. EOKA did so, transforming itself into a political party called EDMA (United Democratic Reconstruction Front).

As independence approached, political activity increased, new leaders emerged, and opposition to the agreements grew. Clashes between the Greek and Turkish communities continued. The provisions of the various treaties, though welcomed by a majority of the population, were not universally popular. The Greek left opposed the provisions that established Greek and Turkish troops on the island. Some mayors were united in their attacks against the provision that allowed for separate Greek and Turkish municipalities as well as the makeup of Archbishop Makarios' advisory council. There was also significant concern regarding the Treaty of Guarantee which, in Archbishop Makarios' view, gave Türkiye legal rights on the island that they had abrogated in 1923 under the terms of the Treaty of Lausanne. However, the greatest overarching concern was that the treaties forced a supposedly independent Cyprus to live virtually under the thumb of three nations, subject to the demands of western security and NATO.

The Republic of Cyprus

In December 1959 the British Governor lifted the four-year state of emergency and the emerging nation held presidential elections for the first time. Archbishop Makarios won the presidency and Turkish Cypriot leader Fazıl Küçük was elected as vice-president. Parliamentary elections were delayed, but finally held in July of 1960. Cyprus became an independent nation on 16 August 1960, and was accepted as the 99th member of the United Nations on 24 August 1960. The new state of Cyprus was by no means a cohesive nation. Neither side felt completely satisfied. The concepts of *enosis* and *taksim* had not been achieved and though Cyprus became independent, it soon became clear that neither community had abandoned their true long-term objectives.

The new Cypriot constitution proved cumbersome – a document designed to placate concerns of all groups rather than to establish an effective framework for governance. In order to get Turkish support for the independence of Cyprus, significant safeguards had been built in to the constitution to guard against discrimination and other issues voiced by the Turkish minority. The Turkish vice-president had the power to veto all matters concerning foreign affairs, defense, and security. The Turkish members of the House of Representatives had the power to block legislation. Disagreements over any measure or issue invariably ground government operation to a halt. Tax laws were not passed, the formation of the Army never got off the ground and, in 1962, Turkish legislators blocked the passage of a budget.

In November 1962 President Makarios presented vice-president Küçük with a thirteen point proposal to amend the constitution. His aim was to correct perceived flaws in the constitution which had forced the government into deadlock and weakened Cypriot sovereignty by allowing foreign troops to be stationed on the island. His proposed changes were seen by the Turkish community as essentially eliminating the provisions designed to safeguard them. Within a week Türkiye, followed by the Turkish Cypriots, rejected the proposal.

On 21 December 1962, the routine traffic stop of a Turkish Cypriot motorist and his passenger, by Greek Cypriot police, turned into a shooting incident, which quickly touched off a new wave of inter-communal violence. The next day, all Turkish government employees left their jobs and Turkish police officers abandoned their posts. The Turkish Cypriots went so far as to force members of Turkish communities living in majority Greek areas to move into the Turkish enclaves, though many resisted. Turkish Air Force jets buzzed the island, raising the possibility of a unilateral Turkish response if other measures were not immediately taken to defuse the situation. Pleas for calm came from all quarters, to include the Greek and Turkish governments, but matters were clearly beyond the ability of local civil authorities to control. On Christmas Day, an agreement was reached to establish a British intervention force which successfully brought a moderate degree of stability to the island – for the time being.

As the crisis abated, talks began for a long-term solution. The Greek Cypriots advocated constitutional amendments that would make it easier to execute majority rule, while the Turkish Cypriots advocated for adherence to already established constitutional safeguards. British leaders knew that mediation by a neutral party had the best chance of success. Both the United States and NATO were considered for the role, but neither accepted. While the British were hesitant to involve the UN, there remained no other logical choice. In late 1963, Britain asked the UN to take up the issue. On 4 March 1964 the UN Security Council passed Resolution 186 (1964), recommending the creation and dispatch of a UN Peacekeeping Force for a period of three months and the appointment of a UN Mediator.

The UN had difficulty recruiting “acceptable” nations willing to provide the troops needed for the peacekeeping force. With the small British intervention force unable to maintain stability, the situation on the island began to deteriorate. Türkiye threatened to take matters into its own hands, and only pressure from the US kept the Turks from military action. Eventually, through British assistance, UN Secretary-General U Thant was able to secure the needed international support. The UN Peacekeeping Force in Cyprus (UNFICYP), composed of some 6400 troops from Britain, Ireland, Canada, Sweden, and Finland, became operational on 27 March 1964. UNFICYP’s activation did little to suppress inter-communal conflict, militarization of the island, and continued consolidation of the two communities into their own sectors. In August 1964 the Turkish Air force supported Turkish Cypriot actions on the ground. Resulting in the sinking of one patrol boat and damaging another. During the attack a Turkish jet was shot down and pilot bailed out. When he landed on Cypriot soil he was beaten to death by local villagers. Pressure from the US, the Soviet Union, and the UN helped calm the situation. From that point, as skirmishes continued, each community concentrated on building and securing their separate sectors.



Cyriot Patrol Boat Phaethon

In November 1967, tensions again escalated and Ankara was determined to take definitive action. Under the threat of immediate invasion, Greece acceded to Turkish demands; that it recall the Greek military force, disarm Greek Cypriot organizations, pay an indemnity for Turkish losses, and cease all pressure on the Turkish community. Tensions abated, paving the way for the initiation of direct talks between the two communities mediated by the UN. Over the course of several years, while lesser issues were agreed to, the two sides made no progress on the larger issues of governance and self-determination.

A Nation Divided

President Makarios won reelection in 1968, but continually lived under threat of assassination from Greek extremist groups in retaliation to his abandonment of *enosis*. The Greek government, a crumbling dictatorship desperate for a regime change, secretly supported a plot by EOKA-B to overthrow Makarios. EOKA-B was the re-envisioned organization founded by Georgios Grivas two



Glafcos Clerides

decades earlier. On 15 July 1974 a coup attempt was made by EOKA-B but President Makarios escaped to the coastal city of Paphos and came under British protection. The Cypriot Army installed Nikos Sampson as the de facto president and he was quickly followed by Glafcos Clerides. In reaction, Türkiye requested the insertion of a joint British-Turkish force to restore the legitimate government. The British declined to act in the hopes of reaching a diplomatic solution. With this Türkiye decided to take more definitive action and invaded Cyprus on 20 July 1974.

The Turkish invasion force overwhelmed the Greek Cypriot defenses. The British force on the island did not intervene against a NATO ally and withdrew into their sovereign bases. The UNFICYP kept clear of any involvement. The US government did little to publically or privately dissuade Türkiye from their course of action. As a consequence, Türkiye openly ignored UN Security Council resolutions for the cessation of hostilities. Turkish forces ended up controlling 37% of the island and approximately 200,000 peoples were displaced from their homes. The separation of the island was complete and the cease-fire line is referred to as the Green Line.

Archbishop Makarios returned from exile in January 1975 and resumed his presidency. With internal pressure from within Greek Cypriot leaders, proposals were offered to keep Cyprus intact as a single nation with a strong central government, but with broad autonomy and self-governance for the Turkish Cypriot community. The Turkish Cypriots in turn declared the creation of the Turkish Federal State of Cyprus on 13 February. President Makarios appealed to the UN for assistance. The UN Security Council passed resolution 367 (1975) which requested UN Secretary General Kurt Waldheim employ his good offices to advance the talks.

The UN mediated the Vienna Talks between Greek and Turkish Cypriot leaders. Representatives of the Greek and Turkish governments signed an accord endorsing a package deal approach to resolve territorial and federal issues, but an agreement could not be reached with the Greek Cypriot community. The major points of contention was Makarios' demand for a multiregional federation, while the Turks insisted on the complete separation of the two communities with a government composed of two federal bodies representing each community and a weak central governing body composed of equal representation from both communities. Meanwhile, the Turkish Cypriots continued to develop the TFSC as a completely independent entity; holding presidential and parliamentary elections in 1976, with Rauf Denktaş elected as President.

In February 1977 President Denktaş reached out to President Makarios, suggesting that the two meet. The talks were friendly and significant progress was made toward the establishment of a common set of guidelines for further discussion. UN Secretary-General Waldheim joined in the discussions and reported agreements on the following guidelines:



President Makarios, Secretary-General Waldheim, and President Denktaş

1. We are seeking an independent, non-aligned, bi-communal federal republic.
2. The territory under the administration of each community should be discussed in the light of economic viability or productivity and land ownership.
3. Questions of principles like freedom of movement, freedom of settlement, the right of property, and other specific matters, are open for discussion taking into consideration the fundamental basis of a bi-communal federal system and certain practical difficulties which may arise for the Turkish Cypriot community.
4. The powers and functions of the Central Federal Government will be such as to safeguard the unity of the country, having regard to the bi-communal character of the State.

The guidelines were controversial within the Greek Cypriot community. They were considered major concessions by President Makarios, as point 2 was interpreted as an abandonment of Greek Cypriot position advocating multiregional or cantonal federation, without any *quid pro quo* from the Turkish Cypriots. Second, there was confusion over the meaning of bi-communal and if it meant or implied bi-zonal. President Makarios envisioned a restored island where its citizens would exist in pre-invasion state where combined Greek and Turkish communities co-existed.

To the Greek Cypriots; *Bi-communal* means that the two communities will participate effectively (proportionally) in the central federal government. *Bi-zonal* means one nation comprised of a strong central federal government with two subordinate communities represented proportionally without boundaries between the communities or defining the communities.

To the Turkish Cypriots; *Bi-communal* means that the two communities will be separate within a single nation with equal representation in the central government. *Bi-zonal* means one nation comprised of two sovereign federal states with borders and both communities equally represented within a weak central government.

Progress in these talks came about through the pressure exerted by the new US administration. President Carter took a very different approach to the problem. He served notice to both Greece and Türkiye to take the necessary measures to repair their relations. He was especially blunt with the Turkish government, stating that they must reach an acceptable agreement on Cyprus if Ankara wanted improved relations with the United States. Turkish leaders responded by promising that a Cyprus settlement was their highest priority. President Makarios anxiously made concessions in the hopes that President Carter would pressure Turkish leaders to respond in kind. But he would never know – on 3 August 1977, President Makarios died. He was replaced by Spyros Kyprianou.



Spyros Kyprianou

In April 1978 Turkish Cypriots submitted the Soysal Proposals to UN Secretary-General Waldheim. President Kyprianou quickly rejected them as they altered little from previous Turkish Cypriot positions and offered only very minor territorial adjustments. The proposal also retained the Turkish position that the two state parliaments would be the principal legislative institutions, with a weak central government, and a federal chamber that would equally represent each community.

In November, the US submitted an American-Canadian-British effort called a 'Framework for a Cyprus Settlement,' or the "Nimetz Plan." It called for a reduction in the size of the Turkish areas, including the return of a small portion of the Varosha area. The proposal was not given serious consideration by either side. It was not until the spring of 1979 that discussions between the Greek and Turkish Cypriot leaders, Kyprianou and Denktaş, mediated by Waldheim produced another agreement – the Waldheim Discussion Papers – which appeared to set a new path for moving forward. However, the ensuing talks quickly bogged down over the concept of "bi-zonality."

Issues for Resolution

It was not until 1980 that the UN was able to get Cypriot leaders to resume inter-communal talks without preconditions. The talks were divided into four major areas of discussion/concern: 1) Resettlement of Varosha by Greek Cypriots, 2) Identification of practical measures to promote goodwill and build confidence, 3) Constitutional issues, and 4) Territorial issues.

Finally, it was agreed that issues of security could be discussed. Waldheim explored the possibility achieving a small interim agreement on Varosha. He proposed the resettlement of Varosha in exchange for the reopening of the Nicosia airport, with both under interim UN administration. President Denktaş, while agreeing to open up certain areas of the town, refused to entertain the possibility of ceding Turkish Cypriot control of the area.



Varosha Seaside Resort Area

Meanwhile, in September of 1980 the civilian government of Türkiye was again overthrown by the military. In Greece, elections held in October of 1981 ended 50-years of conservative rule in favor of a firmly leftwing government, headed by Andreas Papandreou. Papandreou reversed the Greek position on Cyprus, and promoted it as a 'vital national

issue' for Greece. Additionally, he believed that foreign intervention had created the Cyprus problem. Back on Cyprus, both Denktaş (May 1981) and Kyprianou (February 1983) were reelected to their posts.

In February of 1983, President Reagan called on Türkiye to remove its forces from Cyprus and the May 1983 UN General Assembly Resolution 37/253 demanded "the immediate the withdrawal of all occupation forces from the Republic of Cyprus." The Turkish Cypriots immediately withdrew from the talks and Denktaş asserted that he was prepared to declare the independence of the Turkish-Cypriot State.

Pérez de Cuéllar, the new UN Secretary-General, enticed both parties back to the table through employment of his "indicators" initiative. Both Denktaş and Kyprianou accepted his invitation. When discussions began on 15 November, Denktaş opened by declaring the independence of the Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus. The UN Security Council, formalized in UNSCR 541 (1983), denounced the act as "legally invalid," and called upon "all States not to recognize any Cypriot State other than the Republic of Cyprus." This act jolted the UN mediated talks into a new direction and compelled the leaders of the Greek Cypriots and Turkish Cypriots to meet in face-to-face negotiations.



TRNC Declaration of Independence

In August 1991, President Bush brought the Greek Prime Minister, Konstantine Mitsotakis and the President of Türkiye, Turgut Özal, together to push towards a peace conference. In November, the new Turkish President, Mesut Yılmaz, renounced all positions taken by his predecessor and stated that a peace conference was infeasible. In 1992 UN Secretary-General Boutros Boutros-Ghali's "Set of Ideas" was endorsed by the UN Security Council in Resolution 750 (1992). This document set out the details of a potential agreement based on "a bi-communal and bi-zonal federation," along with a map detailing community boundaries. Further talks refined the document, but continued Turkish Cypriot intransigence frustrated efforts to achieve the key compromises that might lead to a final settlement.

In May 1993 Boutros-Ghali introduced a package of confidence building measures (CBMs) that promised to help reduce mistrust between the two communities and create the atmosphere needed to achieve final settlement. The Secretary-General proposed simultaneous reopening of Varosha and the Nicosia International Airport (both to be administered under the UN) as the first CBMs implemented. Glafcos Clerides, new President of the Republic of Cyprus, accepted with some reservation, Denktaş stated that he needed to return to Cyprus to confer on the CBM's acceptance. Once back in Cyprus, Denktaş denounced the package. It wasn't until early 1994 that he finally accepted the CBMs along with the talks needed to determine their implementation. It soon became clear that neither the Turkish Cypriot leaders nor the Turkish government had the political support of their populations to conclude a comprehensive peace agreement.



ATACMS

In March 1995, the European Union agreed on the initiation of negotiations for the entry of the Republic of Cyprus into the union. The Turks reacted by warning that any move toward accession of the Republic of Cyprus would jeopardize 'federation as the sole form of settlement,' or risk war. Turkish leaders began to openly talk of the possible of annexation of Northern Cyprus. In March, the defense ministers of Cyprus and Greece signed the Joint Defense Doctrine, committing Greece to aid Cyprus in the event of war, and Greek leaders threatened to establish a 'missile umbrella' over Cyprus. In September the

Greek military participated in a Cyprus military exercise, but bowed to US pressure not to land paratroopers on the island to prevent provocation of Türkiye. In December 1995, the Clinton administration proposed the sale of 120 Army Tactical Missile Systems (ATACMS surface-to-surface missiles) to Türkiye (along with 71 to Greece), which brought on a much larger crisis. If delivered, this highly accurate missile system could easily range Cyprus from mainland Türkiye.

In 1996, British Foreign Secretary Malcolm Rifkind devised a ten-point framework to revive the UN's inter-communal talks, aiming for a settlement prior to the EU's initiation of Cyprus accession talks. His efforts did not succeed.

In January 1997, the Republic of Cyprus approved the purchase of 36 Russian S-300 surface-to-air missile systems as a countermeasure to Türkiye's ATACMS, with delivery scheduled for late-1998. The crisis, which saw brinkmanship from both Greece and Türkiye, ended in December 1999, when special US envoy Carey Cavanaugh convinced Greek Cypriot President Clerides against deploying the missiles on Cyprus. Instead the Greek government accepted their delivery to Crete, a move unopposed by Türkiye. Meanwhile, as the scheduled initiation of Cyprus' EU accession negotiations approached, Denktaş broke off any further talks, and eventually insisted that any future negotiations be interstate rather than inter-communal.

Seismic Shifts and the Annan Plan

With the 1990s ending, the European Council's EU accession talks on Cyprus were, in part, meant to incentivize both communities to reach a settlement. The hope was that Cyprus would be a united nation when it became an EU member (although it was not a precondition). The Greeks and the Greek Cypriots desired their accession to the union, seeing it as an opportunity to counter the dominance that Türkiye had held since its 1974 invasion. They also hoped to gain leverage over the Turks by playing on Turkish aspirations to be regarded as a European nation and Ankara's own desire for EU accession.

A series of unforeseen and unrelated events in 1999 laid the groundwork for a meaningful thaw in the relations between Greece and Türkiye. A complete shakeup of the Greek government in February 1999, followed by Greek humanitarian assistance during the devastating earthquakes in Türkiye later that year ushered in a period of cooperation and rapprochement. Within this new atmosphere, the character of the stalemate began to change as the EU pledged its full support to UN efforts for a solution. This fundamental shift created space for a new UN initiative that would bring together UN Secretary-General Kofi Annan, the US and the UK in an effort known as the *Annan Plan*. Efforts began with discussions held in conjunction with the June 1999 G8 summit in Bonn, Germany. The process continued with all sides working to bring an all-inclusive approach to future negotiations to the UN and the passage of UN Security Council Resolution 1250 (1999). Among other things, UNSCR 1250 outlined an approach that continues to guide negotiation efforts:

- No preconditions;
- All issues on the table;
- Commitment in good faith to continue to negotiate until a settlement is reached;



Devastation from the İzmit earthquake

- Full consideration of relevant United Nations resolutions and treaties.

In 2002 the rise of the Islamic AK party and the election of the party leader, Recep Erdoğan, as the Prime Minister of Türkiye changed the dynamic of the Turkish positions in the negotiations. Both the Islamic AK party and Erdoğan were determined to bring their nation into the EU, which meant finding a solution to the Cyprus problem. Over time, the shift in Türkiye's position toward compromise on Cyprus allowed the rise of moderate voices within the Turkish Cypriot community, which undercut Denktaş' intransigence and forced him toward compromise.

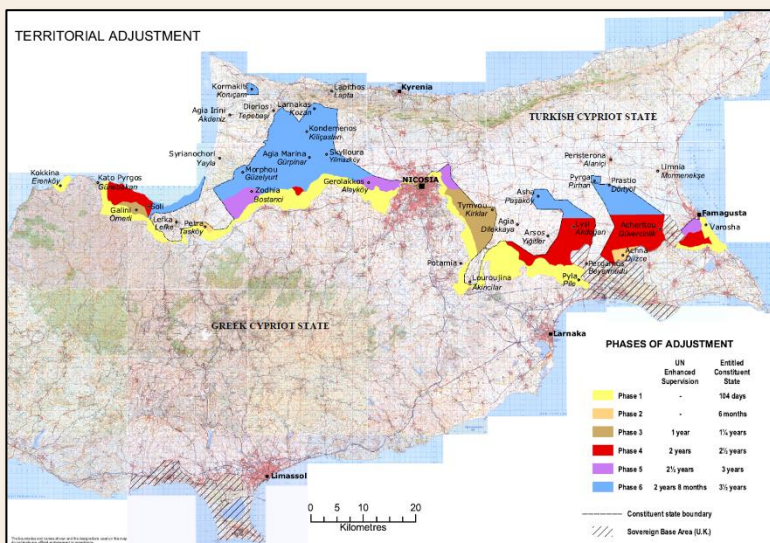


Recep Erdoğan

UN Secretary-General Annan submitted his plan on 11 November 2002. Entitled "Basis for Agreement on a Comprehensive Settlement of the Cyprus Problem" (Annan I), which consisted of a set of proposals and a timeline for a settlement date of February 28, 2003. Cyprus' EU accession date was set for 1 May 2004. Annan's original plan underwent several challenges, failures and revisions – Annan II (10 December 2002), Annan III (26 February 2003), and Annan IV (9 March 2004). In a final push, Annan invited the Greek and Turkish Cypriot leaders, and representatives of the Greece, Türkiye and the UK to negotiations in New York. After three days, Denktaş (on instructions from Ankara), Greek Cypriot President Papadopoulos, and the original three guarantor powers agreed to a three-stage process:

Stage one consisted of direct talks between the leaders of the two communities. These talks failed to reach an agreement by the agreed deadline of 22 March. Their failure automatically pushed the talks to the second stage with the addition of representatives from Greece and Türkiye. Held near Lucerne, Switzerland, these talks also failed to achieve an agreement by the next deadline, 29 March. This failure immediately initiated the third stage, with the Secretary-General finalizing the latest version of the draft agreement for submission in separate referenda to be held simultaneously within each community. Annan finished the final text of the agreement (Annan V) on 31 March 2004. Voting on the Annan agreement took place in Cyprus on 24 April, exactly a week prior to the Republic of Cyprus' EU accession date.

The Annan V agreement was significantly complex. It consisted of a foundation agreement and five appendices: constituent state constitutions, treaty matters, draft EU accession act, matters for UN Security Council decision, and measures for April 2004. The foundation agreement committed both



Annan V Territorial Adjustment Phases

communities to a set of principles which acknowledge their "bi-zonal partnership," a renunciation of violence, and an acknowledgement that their relationship was "not one of majority and minority, but of political equality." The 1960 Treaties; Alliance, Guarantee, and Establishment, would remain in force with accepted changes, including a reduction in the size of the British Secure Basing Areas.

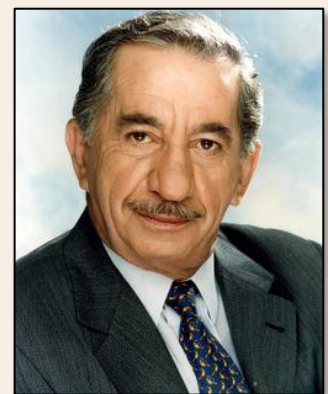
The new nation, the United Republic of Cyprus, would be based on the Swiss model, with two equal constituent states Turkish Cypriot and Greek

Cypriot with a “single international personality.” There would be a single Cypriot citizenship and an “internal constituent state citizenship,” with strict graduated limitations on the percentage of how many from one community who could reside in the other. The federal government would be composed of two chambers – a Senate and a Chamber of Deputies – each with 48 members. The Senate would be composed of an equal number of representatives from the Greek and Turkish states; the Chamber of Deputies would have proportional representation, with each state guaranteed a minimum of one-fourth of the Chamber’s members. Executive power, to include the head of state, would be held and exercised by a Presidential Council, composed of six members elected from a “single list” by a special majority in the Senate and a simple majority in Deputies chamber. The posts of President and Vice President, one from each state, would be elected by the Council and would rotate annually. The Treaty of Guarantee would be extended to cover “the territorial integrity, security, and constitutional order of the constituent states.” Under the Treaty of Alliance, Greek and Turkish forces would be phased until they reached the treaty’s figure of 950 Greek and 650 Turkish troops, all overseen by a Monitoring Committee. All other military forces would be dissolved and the UN peacekeeping mission would be extended as needed. Territorial adjustments would take place in six phases over a 42 month period, to include the return of Varosha and Morphou, which would allow 54% of the displaced Greek Cypriots to return to their homes and lands.

Property rights would be “resolved in a comprehensive manner” through respect for the rights of the “dispossessed owners,” the “current users,” and the “principle of bi-zonality.” An independent property board would be established to deal with all claims through either reinstatement or compensation. No current user would be displaced until alternate accommodations were secured and made available. Lastly, the agreement included provisions meant to facilitate inter-communal dialogue and understanding in the form of a reconciliation commission, composed of an equal number of members from each community and headed by a non-Cypriot to be appointed by the UN Secretary-General.

Between 31 March and 24 April 2004, the political factions within each community campaigned vigorously for and against the proposed settlement. In a departure from their historic positions, the Turkish community voted in favor of the agreement (69.9%), while the Greek Cypriot community was adamantly opposed (75.8%).

Since the beginning of Annan’s efforts, polling within the Greek Cypriot community reflected a rejectionist attitude among the population, with 52 to 86 percent against the various Annan proposals. There were several reasons for this. First, President Papadopoulos was elected to the Greek Cypriot presidency in 2003 on a platform of taking a hardline approach to the bi-zonal/bi-communal issue. *“I received a state,”* Papadopoulos would say, *“I will not deliver a community.”* When it became clear that Denktas would say “yes,” Papadopoulos was then forced to say “no.” Second, the certainty of EU membership for Cyprus strengthened their hand but required nothing of them. Third, Annan’s agreement neither allayed Greek Cypriot security concerns nor did it address their emotional, ancestral ties to property. Fourth, the new conservative Greek government in Athens, led by Kostas Karamanlis, privately continued to maintain the old policy of “Cyprus decides and Greece supports.” However, late pressure from the US and the UK finally persuaded Karamanlis to break with Papadopoulos position and demonstrate support for the Annan Plan, but his endorsement came late and had little actual impact.



Tassos Papadopoulos

Equally misunderstood was the Turkish Cypriot community’s vote in favor of the agreement when, in the past, their leaders had always rejected unification. The appeal of EU accession to the Turkish

Cypriots cannot be overstated. It came at a time when there was a clear economic separation between the Greek Cypriots and the Turkish Cypriots. As an internationally recognized nation, the Republic of Cyprus had developed a thriving economy, while, as an unrecognized state, the TRNC was in sustained economic decline, relying substantially on Türkiye for their economic wellbeing, unable to act independently of Türkiye. The new liberal leaders, in opposing Denktaş' historic intransigence, believed that inclusion in a united Cypriot nation within the EU held the most promise for the future of their community, whatever the cost. Turkish leaders supported this view as they were determined to clear obstructions to their own EU membership, which in part required a solution of the Cyprus problem.

Post-Referendum: The Stalemate Continues

On 1 May 2004, the Republic of Cyprus joined the EU; however the *acquis communautaire* was suspended for the Turkish portion of the island. In order to assure that the Green Line did not become a *de facto* international border, an EU regulation granted EU citizen rights to Turkish Cypriots who had been residents of the island prior to 1974, and their spouses and descendants. The EU also encouraged intra-island trade.

In 2006, the UN again began to put pressure to both sides to reenter negotiations. The agreement known as the "8 July Agreement" consisted of a five-point declaration which included a commitment to a bi-zonal, bi-communal federation with political equality. After fourteen months and 52 meetings, these talks failed to make substantive progress.

In September 2008, Greek Cypriot President Dimitris Christofias and Turkish Cypriot Present Mehmet Talat agreed to begin weekly face-to-face talks without the presence of third parties (but facilitated by the UN) in hopes of developing an agreement that they could present to their communities within a year. They approached the negotiations under a UN construct, and broke the major issues into six chapters: Governance and Power-sharing, EU Matters, Economy, Property, Territory, and Security and Guarantees. Separately, the Greek Cypriots also regarded Citizenship and Settlers as a seventh chapter, but at that time it was rejected by the Turkish Cypriots.



Mehmet Talat and Dimitris Christofias

In April 2008, both leaders agreed to open the Ledra crossing point in Nicosia; in May they agreed that Cyprus should be a nation under the federation concept with two constituent states and a "single international personality"; and in July they agreed on the principle of single sovereignty and citizenship. Over the next two years they concentrated on the chapters regarding the economy and EU matters, resolving most issues, such as the establishment of a Cyprus central bank. However, despite their friendship and mutual respect, progress began to slow, in large part due to internal opposition on both sides to some of the points of agreement. Though they missed their self-imposed one-year deadline they continued their talks.

In 2010, the last agreement was to open the Limintis crossing point. Shortly thereafter, talks were interrupted by Turkish Cypriot elections in April, in which Talat was defeated by Dr. Derviş Eroğlu. The electorate's disillusionment with the lack of significant movement towards a final settlement ousted Talat. Dr. Eroğlu was a hard-line leader who opposed the "bi-zonal, bi-communal federation" concept. Once in office, and with the support of (or pressure from) Ankara, he vowed that the talks would continue. The UN hoped to focus the negotiators on the Property chapter, but progress slowed even further, as both sides emplaced greater and greater obstacles toward reaching a settlement.

Finally, in March 2012, talks were suspended indefinitely, due to the global financial crisis on the EU's member states, especially Greece and Cyprus.

The Cypriot banks had long been held up with emergency funding from the European Central Bank. There were many speculations that Cypriot banks had become a 'tax haven' for Russian depositors, allowing them to get access to European financial markets. Their overleveraged positions came to a head in 2012 and led to island's financial crisis. With the Cypriot government's bond credit rating downgraded to "junk" status it became unable to fund its state expenses. The Cypriot government, to pay down their debt, began taxing personal savings accounts 6-10%. A run on the banks ensued and the government called a national holiday and closed banks to prevent withdrawals. The move avoided collapse but drew strong criticism from Cypriots. The economy was eventually bailed out by the European troika and a series of austerity measures were imposed in return.

United Kingdom and Cyprus Foreign Ministers meet in January 2014 to sign an agreement on the Sovereign Base Areas (SBA) controlled by the UK. This agreement lays out the conduct of both parties to eventually lift restrictions to develop properties within the British bases area. Approximately 78% of the total base areas could be developed by local administrative units.



Nicos Anastasiades

In February 2014 talks began for the first time since 2010. Greek Cypriot President Anastasiades and Turkish Cypriot President Eroğlu revealed a joint declaration with seven points: 1) The status quo is unacceptable and its prolongation will have negative consequences for the Greek Cypriots and Turkish Cypriots, 2) The leaders expressed their determination to resume structured negotiations in a results-oriented manner, 3) The settlement will be based on a bi-communal, bi-zonal federation with political equality, as set out in the relevant Security Council Resolutions and the High Level Agreements, 4) The united Cyprus federation shall result from the settlement following the settlement's approval by separate simultaneous referenda, 5) The negotiations are based on the principle that nothing is agreed until everything is agreed, 6) The appointed representatives are fully empowered to discuss any issue at any time and should enjoy parallel access to all stakeholders and interested parties in the process, as needed, 7) The sides will seek to create a positive atmosphere to ensure the talks succeed.

In October 2014 the talks stalled as a result of a crisis involving a Turkish warship being sent to Cyprus-controlled waters. The Turkish warship was sent because of off-shore exploration of natural gas reserves in the Republic of Cyprus' EEZ. President Anastasiades refused to meet until the crisis was concluded. This was just one in a long history of conflicts regarding Republic of Cyprus' EEZ and Turkish warships standing off with gas survey ships. In a counter to Türkiye, Anastadiades held talks with Russian President Putin and agreed to let Russian Naval vessels access Cypriot ports.

Northern Cyprus held elections in April 2015 and elected Mustafa Akıncı to the presidency. Akıncı was a long-standing advocate of Cyprus reunification. With his election, Anastadiades agreed to resume talks. Talks commenced in Crans Montana, Switzerland. By December 2015 progress was made on responsibility for foreign policy, Senate and Lower House structure, Supreme Court make-up, and that each federation would have its own Parliament. Unfortunately talks broke down over territorial agreements and citizenship determination, amongst other issues. By November 2016 no agreement was formalized on the issue



Mustafa Akıncı

of territory. In June 2017, UN Secretary-General Antonio Guterres held “highly constructive” talks on Cyprus laying out a “clear vision” that could lead to a settlement. By July 2017 negotiations ceased with both parties yelling at each other. Following the breakdown UN Secretary-General Guterres stated “I wish the next generation good luck on this and that one day maybe Turkish Cypriots and Greek Cypriots will decide together that there is no longer a need for troops on the island.”

The 2018 Cyprus gas dispute began in February. The Turkish Navy blocked an Italian drill ship that was licensed by the Republic of Cyprus to explore gas reserves off of their island. Türkiye claimed that the Turkish Cypriots have “undeniable rights” to Cypriot EEZ. The Greek Cypriot government emphasized that any benefits gained would be for all Cypriots, but only after a comprehensive settlement of the Cyprus problem. In November Exxon-Mobil began carrying out exploration while being escorted by US Navy ships. Türkiye remained passive but stated that they would begin drilling on its own in Cypriot waters.

In February 2019 both Greece and Türkiye stated that they wanted to defuse tensions through dialog, to include the Cyprus dispute and the ongoing gas and oil explorations in the Cyprus EEZ.

The European Council, in July 2019, adopted the following conclusion on Turkish drilling activities:

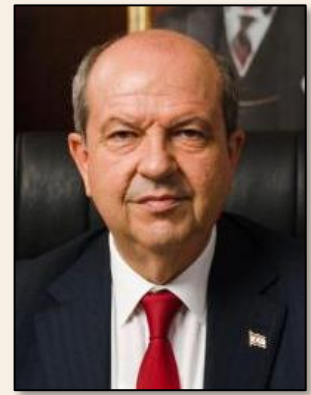
- Calls again on Türkiye to act in a spirit of good neighbourliness and respect the sovereignty and sovereign rights of Cyprus in accordance with international law.
- Welcomes the invitation by the Government of Cyprus to negotiate with Türkiye on delimitation of exclusive economic zones and the continental shelf through dialogue and in full respect of international law.
- The EU remains fully committed to supporting the UN-led efforts to work with the parties with a view to creating the conditions conducive to resuming negotiations on a comprehensive settlement of the Cyprus problem.
- To suspend negotiations on the Comprehensive air transport agreement and not to hold further meetings of the EU-Türkiye high-level dialogues.
- The Council endorses the Commission's proposal to reduce the pre-accession assistance to Türkiye for 2020 and invites the European Investment Bank to review its lending activities in Türkiye.
- In accordance with the European Council conclusions of 20 June, invites the High Representative and the Commission to continue work on options for targeted measures in light of Türkiye's continued drilling activities.
- The Council will closely monitor developments and will revert to this issue as appropriate.

August 2019 Greece, Israel, Cyprus, and the United States meet in Athens to enhance cooperation in energy security. This does little to stem the conflict. Later in October Türkiye sends a drilling ship to waters south of Cyprus where Cyprus had already awarded exploration rights to Italian and French companies. U.S. Secretary of State, Mike Pompeo, warns Türkiye not to engage in drilling activity that is “illegal” and “unacceptable”. The European Union draws up economic sanctions against Turkish oil and gas drilling activities.

Secretary-General Guterres, President Anastasiades, and President Akıncı informally meet for dinner in Berlin on 25 November 2019. Neither Greek Cypriots nor the Turkish Cypriots could agree on “terms of reference” to restart negotiations. In late January 2020 the Special Representative states that there is “growing scepticism as to whether reunification is still possible”.

In February 2020 President Akıncı stated in an interview that if reunification efforts in Cyprus fail the north would grow increasingly dependent on Türkiye. His comments were condemned by Türkiye and calls were made that Akıncı does not deserve to be President.

Akıncı lost his bid for reelection in October 2020. President Ersin Tatar was sworn and is considered a hardliner for Turkish Cypriot Independence and a two-state solution. Ersin has close ties to Turkish President Erdoğan. In November 2020, UN Secretary-General Guterres stated that he'd like to begin "5+1" negotiations between the Greek and Turkish Cypriots and the three guarantors of Greece, Türkiye, and the United Kingdom.

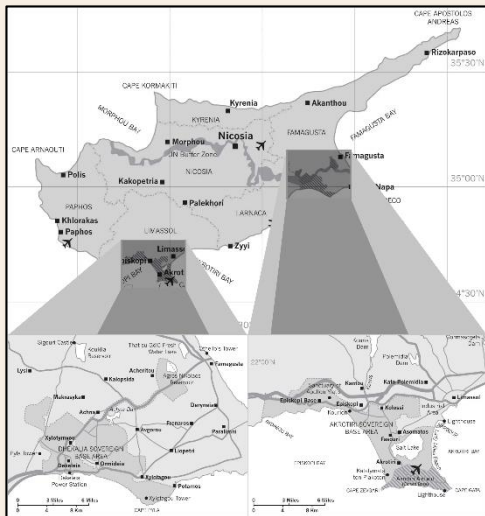


Ersin Tatar

Parties from the Greek and Turkish Cypriots, along with Greece, Türkiye, and the United Kingdom meet in Geneva in April 2021. Turkish Cypriots believe that efforts to negotiate the bi-zonal, bi-communal federation have been exhausted. Additionally they believe that they have "inherent sovereign equality" and is an "equal international status" and that a two-state solution. Greek Cypriots expressed that talks should have resumed where they left off in Crans Montana. They reiterated that their aim to achieve a settlement was based on bi-zonal, bi-communal federation with political equality. The only agreement achieved was that they will convene in the near future another five plus the UN negotiations.

2021 continued to be a standstill in attempts to overcome the divisions on the island. The TRNC suffered both political and economic instability. The ruling coalition collapsed in November. Greek Cypriots experienced losses to the three largest parties in their Parliamentary elections in May. This only caused a reshuffling of the cabinet ministers.

Türkiye threatens to block any "unauthorized" search for gas and oil in, what it considers, its EEZ off Cyprus in December 2021. This follows Cyprus' award for exploration and drilling rights to Exxon Mobil and Qatar Petroleum.



May 2022, the 2014 SBA came into affect at British military installations throughout Cyprus. Approximately 12,000 Cypriots were affected by agreement as they lived in the SBA but could not develop the land to suit their needs. Britain's high commissioner to Cyprus stated "we have worked together to deliver a change that will have a real and positive impact on people's lives."

Following the removal of a 1987 U.S. arm sales embargo, with the Republic of Cyprus, the TRNC submits a Status of Forces Agreement proposal to the United Nations in September 2022. Growing pressure to enter into a mutually agreeable formal agreement for the continuation of the Peacekeeping Force in Cyprus (UNFICYP) comes to a head. Turkish Cypriots say that the semi-annual renewal, by the

UN Security Council, needs to happen with their consent. This presents a legal issue with the United Nations as it does not formally recognize the TRNC.

The SRSR hosted an end of year reception where both Greek Cypriot leader Nicos Anastasiades and Turkish Cypriot leader Ersin Tatar attended. SRSR stated "there is still plenty of potential to resolve the Cyprus issue, and regardless of the challenges, the UN in Cyprus will not relax our efforts to help the two sides arrive at common ground."



Nikos Christodoulides

President Anastasiades's second term came to a close and an election was held in February 2023. Former Foreign Minister, Nikos Christodoulides, ran as an independent against independent Andreas Mavroyiannis. Christodoulides triumphed in a close vote, winning by less than 4-percent, and was inaugurated on the 28th. In his victory, he declared that his prime focus is to find a solution to the Cyprus problem.

President Tatar and President-elect Christodoulides met at the UN SRSG's residence for informal meeting on February 23rd. The Chief of Mission of UNFICYP attended along with the SRSG.

Turkish President Erdoğan wins re-election after a second round of voting in May. This was the first time in Türkiye's history that a second round was required. President Erdoğan enters his third term in office.

In a presentation to the European Parliament, in June 2023, Christodoulides reiterated the need for a comprehensive solution to the occupation of the northern part of Cyprus. He stressed that the occupation is "an open wound to the body of Europe." President Christodoulides petitioned for the appointment of an EU envoy to help break the deadlock.

July 2023 both Tatar and Christodoulides paid a joint visit to the Committee on Missing Persons (CMP) in the UN Buffer Zone in Lefkoşa. Both leaders expressed their appreciation for the efforts of the CMP and vowed to maintain its mission neutral without political influence. Following their CMP visit, President Christodoulides proposed to President Tatar to hold a joint meeting with UN Secretary-General Guterres during the UN General Assembly in September. Tatar reacted positively to the idea but did not confirm. He later stated that talks could resume only if Greek Cypriots recognized the Turkish Cypriots' "sovereign equality."

Greek Prime Minister Kyriakos Mitsotakis visited with Greek Cypriot Leader Christodoulides on July 31st. Mitsotakis stated that he wants to take full advantage of the improving political climate with Türkiye to improve bilateral relations. However, the Prime Minister also said that Erdoğan's outreach to the EU could not come at the expense of efforts to heal the ethnic divisions in Cyprus. High-level talks between Greece and Türkiye are expected later in 2023.

Note: The United States Government does not recognize the "Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus." Usage of the terms "Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus" and "TRNC" in this exercise, being administered by the United States Army War College, is used for educational purposes only and does not reflect a contradiction to the United States Government official stance.

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